

With all these shortcomings, why are we recommending Richard Hooker's site (he happens to be, apart from the Author and Principal Editor, responsible for "Graphic Design" and "Technical Design")? Well, the site "is the culmination of over two years of web-based teaching and learning. The site combines the reading and course materials of two World Cultures courses taught using web-based materials since Fall of 1994. The site is now expanding into a larger resource for a larger population and distribution of students and will eventually consist of a rich anthology of readings, a complete set of textbook materials, a set of interrelated learning modules, and a finished glossary."

We don't really care what it will be some time from now, but what it is now is a collection of some very useful resources. Like the large document on colonial expansion we mentioned above. And if you're looking for something—say the French Revolution—you will find it if you browse hard enough, ignoring some broken links.

The texts are good, period. Here's another sampler, this one from the beginning text on the French Revolution, of which you are, by now, doubtless sick:

*"History has not been kind to Louis XVI; in fact, history is rarely kind to the losers. He is painted as vain, unintelligent, and ineffectual, so clueless that on the day the Bastille was seized by revolutionaries, he wrote in his diary, 'Rien,' 'Nothing happened.'"*

*"It's difficult, however, to really assign any blame. The Revolution itself was an extraordinarily complicated affair; it was principally lit by the antagonisms between the first two and the Third Estate, antagonisms rooted in decades of abuse and frustration. It is certain that Louis XVI failed to maintain the centralization of power; all the forces in France were conspiring to fragment power away from the monarchy."*

(A few pictures stand side by side with the broken links to provide visual relief.)